A Giant Stone Head of a Pharaoh Turns Up in a Yard

From: Popular Mechanics Mined: 2026-10-22 3 min read

A man in Egypt was working in front of his house when he found a pink stone covered in **hieroglyphics**, an ancient picture writing. He called the local officials.

Archaeologists came to dig. Close to the stone, they found a five-foot-tall stone head of **Pharaoh** Ramesses II. He was a famous king who ruled Egypt from about 1279 to 1213 B.C.E.

The head wears a double crown. That shows he ruled both Upper and Lower Egypt. Experts think the whole **statue** was once about 28 feet tall!

The team also found part of a second **statue**. It may show the same king, but pieces are missing.

The finds were in a village in Egypt's Nile Delta. Officials wonder if a lost **temple** for Ramesses II is buried there. Or the pieces may have been moved from somewhere else. **Archaeologists** plan to keep digging.

Word Treasure

hieroglyphics -- Hieroglyphics are picture symbols that ancient Egyptians used for writing.

Archaeologists -- Archaeologists are scientists who dig up and study things from long ago.

Pharaoh -- A pharaoh was a king of ancient Egypt.

statue -- A statue is a carved figure of a person or animal, often made of stone.

temple -- A temple is a building used for worship.

Background you need

Pharaohs were the kings of ancient Egypt, and they built giant statues and temples.

Ramesses II was a famous pharaoh who ruled Egypt for a very long time.

When people find old objects in Egypt, they tell officials so experts can study and protect them.

Break it down

WHO: A homeowner in Egypt, archaeologists and Pharaoh Ramesses II
WHAT: Archaeologists found a giant stone head of Ramesses II and part of a second statue
WHERE: A village in Egypt's Nile Delta
WHY: A man found a carved stone in his yard and called officials, who then dug and found more

Why it matters

Telling grown-ups or experts about a special find can help everyone learn about history.

Test what you remember

1. What did the man find in front of his house?

- (A) A dinosaur bone
- (B) A pink stone with hieroglyphics
- (C) A treasure chest
- (D) A sword

2. Whose stone head did archaeologists find?

- (A) Pharaoh Ramesses II
- (B) A Viking king
- (C) A Roman emperor
- (D) A Greek god

3. How tall is the stone head?

- (A) Five feet
- (B) One inch
- (C) Two feet
- (D) 100 feet

4. What does the double crown show?

- (A) He liked hats
- (B) He ruled Upper and Lower Egypt
- (C) He won a race
- (D) He was a soldier

5. How tall was the whole statue once?

- (A) About 28 feet
- (B) About 3 feet
- (C) About 1 foot
- (D) About 500 feet

6. What might be buried there?

- (A) A city of gold
- (B) A lost temple
- (C) A pirate ship
- (D) A spaceship

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: A 4: B 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Egyptian officials: Wonder if a lost temple for Ramesses II is buried there.

2. Archaeologists: Think the pieces may have been moved from somewhere else and plan to keep digging.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):